LLL-T-1332A
October 26, 1973
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. LLL-T-001332(GSA-FSS)
September 21, 1967

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TOOTHPICKS (WOOD)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers both round and flat hardwood toothpicks.

1.2 Classification. Toothpicks furnished under this specification shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Flat.

Type II - Round.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes; Paperboard, Metal Edged and Components.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.
PPP-C-55 - Cans, Fiberboard, and Paperboard (With Paper and Metal Ends).
PPP-C-96 - Cans, Metal, 28 Gage and Lighter.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified,the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

U. S. Department of Health, Education and Welfare (HEW):

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the toothpicks shall be fabricated from white birch wood. The wood shall conform to the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

3.2 Dimensions. The dimensions of the toothpicks shall meet the limitations specified below:

Type I - Flat

Length - 2-1/4 inches ± 5 percent.
Width:
Wide end - 0.095 inch, maximum; 0.070 inch, minimum.
Narrow end - 0.040 ± 0.003 inch.
Thickness:
Center, within 3/4 inch of ends - 0.055 inch, maximum; 0.035 inch, minimum.
Ends - 0.023 inch, maximum; 0.012 inch, minimum.

Type II - Round

Length - 2-1/2 inches ± 5 percent.
Diameter:
Center - 0.095 inch, maximum; 0.080 inch, minimum.
Ends - 0.020 inch, maximum.

3.3 Construction. The toothpicks shall be made with the grain of the wood running in the same direction as the long axis of the toothpick. The flat toothpick shall be tapered on one end. The round toothpick shall be tapered on both ends.

3.4 Finish. The type I, flat toothpick shall have a smooth, flat veneer, natural finish. The type II, round toothpick shall have a smooth, natural, straight grain dowel finish. Both types shall be uniform in color.

3.5 Odor and taste. The toothpicks shall impart no objectionable odor or taste when tested in accordance with 4.4.1.

3.6 Workmanship. The toothpicks shall be clean, free from surface checks, splinters, rough edges, or any other defects which may be harmful to the user, or which may affect appearance or serviceability.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Lot. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), a lot shall consist of all toothpicks of the same type submitted for inspection at the same time.

4.2.2 Visual and dimensional examination of end item. Sampling for this examination shall be according to level S-3 in MIL-STD-105. The Acceptable Quality Levels (AQL's) for defects listed in table I shall be 2.5 percent defective for major defects and 4.0 percent defective for minor defects.

4.2.3 Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be in accordance with level S-2 in MIL-STD-105. The AQL for tests shall be 6.5 on the basis of percent defective.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 End item. Toothpicks selected in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for defects listed in table I.

TABLE I. Classification of defects, end item

Defect	Major	Minor
Type not as specified	X	
Dimensions not as specified	X	
Grain of wood not running in same direction as long axis	X	
Not clean	X	
Finish not smooth	X	
Rough edges or splinters	X	
Defects or damage affecting function or serviceability	X	
Defects or damage not affecting function or serviceability		X

4.3.2 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements in section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4 defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect, illegible, improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Distortion of the container.
Contents (exterior and interior container)	Number per container more or less than required. Net weight not as specified.

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4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Odor and taste. Immerse toothpicks in distilled water at 180° ± 5°F. for 15 minutes, then compare the sample water with that of freshly distilled water at the same temperature and contained for the same length of time (see 3.5).

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Type I, flat toothpicks. Seven hundred fifty flat toothpicks shall be packaged in a snug-fitting fiberboard can with metal ends conforming to PPP-C-55 or a metal can conforming to PPP-C-96.

5.1.1.2 Type II, round toothpicks. Two hundred fifty round toothpicks shall be packaged in a snug-fitting fiberboard can with metal ends conforming to PPP-C-55.

5.1.2 Level B.

5.1.2.1 Type I, flat toothpicks. Seven hundred fifty flat toothpicks shall be packaged in a snug-fitting paperboard box conforming to PPP-B-566 except commercially colored boxes shall be acceptable. Each box shall be secured to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.2.2 Type II, round toothpicks. Two hundred fifty round toothpicks shall be packaged in a snug-fitting paperboard box conforming to PPP-B-566, except that commercially colored boxes shall be acceptable.

5.1.3 Level C. The number of toothpicks indicated in the procurement document shall be packaged in a container of the type normally used for the item to afford protection from the supply source to the first receiving activity.

5.1.4 Intermediate packaging. Forty-eight unit packages of toothpicks of one-stock number, shall be intermediate packaged in a paperboard or fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, PPP-B-676, or PPP-B-636. Each box shall be secured to prevent accidental opening.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Ten intermediate packages, packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall meet the special requirements of table II of the box specification. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Ten intermediate packages, packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall meet special requirements of table I of the box specification. The box shall be closed in accordance with method I of the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. The toothpicks packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination in containers complying with the National Motor Freight Classification rules or the Uniform Freight Classification rules, as applicable

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, the packages, except commercially colored boxes as noted in 5.1.2.1 and 5.1.2.2, and shipping containers shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2, as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military requirements. Mrking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. A device used for removing particles of food from the teeth. They may also be used in the preparation and serving of foods, e.g., appetizers.

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6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type (see 1.2).
(c) Species of wood, if different from 3.1.
(d) Size of lot, if different from 4.2.1.
(e) Selection of the applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) Marking required (see 5.3).

6.3 Type II, round toothpicks. Point sizes on the round toothpicks will vary due to rounding operations.

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

GSA-FSS
VA-DMS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with the General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 10 cents each.

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